



BHEDIYA *(2022)*
Son of a forest ranger, director Amar Kaushik grew up in the sylvan environs of Medo, Arunachal Pradesh. For his film, he went back to the state to centre the story around the local folklore of shapeshifting werewolf Yapum, and cast local Paalin Kabak in a meaty part

FIGHTER *(2024)*
When it comes to shooting authentic aerial action sequences in India, nothing beats the IAF base in Tezpur, Assam. That's where Hrithik Roshan and Anil Kapoor headed

PAATAL LOK *(2025)*
Kohima and Dimapur in Nagaland are the setting for a chunk of the drama in Season 2 of the Amazon Prime series. The cast features a host of local musicians, YouTubers and professionals, says Anungla Zoe Longkumer, associate researcher, translator and dialogue coach



THE WORLD OF ENTERTAINMENT, James Handique is someone you'd call 'hot property'. Well-connected with deputy commissioners, director-generals and superintendents of police in the Northeastern states, the Assam-based line producer can procure quick permissions for film shoots in the vast, unexplored region. From Kangana Ranaut's Manikarnika Films, which shot portions of *Emergency* (2025) in Kaziranga and Chandubi in Assam and also in Meghalaya, to the upcoming season of the popular Amazon Prime series *Family Man* (2019-), which recently wrapped up a shoot in Kohima, Nagaland and Assam's Karbi Anglong and Kaziranga, Handique handles crews of hundreds and ensures the show goes on.

Handique's busy schedule is proof of how the Northeast is becoming a go-to destination for Mumbai-based studios. With locations like Kashmir, New Delhi and Lucknow overexposed, Mumbai-based creators are discovering the unexplored charms of the Northeast. And not just as exotic location with colourful cultural motifs (*Jewel Thief*) or picturesque backdrop to a romantic number (Shah Rukh and Madhuri Dixit-starrer *Koyla*) but with a narrative and characters all its own. Hence the new culture, language, costume and environs viewers are seeing in Season 2 of Prime Video's *Paatal Lok*, which travelled to